

FORMAL ETHICS COMPLAINT

TO: Minnesota Board of School Administrators (BOSA)

Bosa.Ethics.Committee.MDE@state.mn.us

Minneapolis, MN 55413

COMPLAINANT: [REDACTED] (Minor Student)

RESPONDENT: Michael Thomas, Superintendent, Prior Lake-Savage Area Schools (ISD 719)

I. INTRODUCTION AND JURISDICTION

This is a formal ethics complaint filed against Superintendent Michael Thomas regarding systematic violations of the Minnesota Code of Ethics for School Administrators (Minnesota Rule 3512.5200). As the Superintendent and designated Responsible Authority for Prior Lake-Savage Area Schools, Michael Thomas oversaw a pattern of administrative misconduct characterized by the failure to protect student safety, the unauthorized disclosure of private educational data, and the willful misrepresentation and spoliation of public records to conceal institutional failures.

II. VIOLATIONS OF THE CODE OF ETHICS (MINN. RULE 3512.5200)

Standard B: Failure to Protect Student Health and Safety

"A school administrator shall take reasonable action to protect students and staff from conditions harmful to health and safety."

Following a violent assault on October 29, 2024, in which a minor student was struck repeatedly with a chair (Exhibit 1), Superintendent Thomas was formally notified of the District's failure to enforce its Weapons Policy (Policy 506). Despite receiving direct notification (Exhibit 5), Superintendent Thomas failed to ensure an investigation into the weapons violation or implement a safety plan. Instead, he oversaw a constructive exclusion that required the student to return to the unsafe environment before safety could be discussed, effectively barring the student from educational access (Exhibit 4).

Standard K: Dishonesty, Fraud, or Misrepresentation

"A school administrator shall not engage in conduct involving dishonesty, fraud, or misrepresentation in the performance of professional duties."

Superintendent Thomas, as the Responsible Authority, oversaw the bad-faith response to multiple data requests. Between January and March 2025, his administration officially stated the District "has no further responsive data" and claimed not to understand requests for Google Workspace Email Logs. However, on March 14, 2025, the District produced the exact log format previously denied, but **intentionally truncated the log** to exclude critical dates related to an

unauthorized data forwarding event and a Title IX filtering failure (Exhibit 5). This targeted spoliation of evidence constitutes a willful misrepresentation of facts to a parent and the public.

Standard E: Unauthorized Disclosure of Confidential Information

"A school administrator shall disclose confidential information about individuals only when a compelling professional purpose is served in accordance with state and federal laws..."

Technical evidence from a December 20, 2024, bounce-back notification proves that Superintendent Thomas's account (mthomas@plsas.org) or a system under his direct control attempted to automatically forward private student data to an external, unauthorized system (Exhibit 5). There is no compelling professional purpose served by the unauthorized, automatic relay of sensitive student data to non-district systems, which represents a violation of both MGDPA and FERPA, and thus the professional Code of Ethics.

Standard F: Misrepresentation of Records

"A school administrator shall not knowingly falsify or misrepresent records or facts..."

In official reports overseen by Superintendent Thomas, the parents' request for trauma-informed accommodations for a student victim was knowingly characterized as a "refusal" to participate (Exhibit 3). This characterization was used to justify the dismissal of a Title IX complaint, representing a malicious misrepresentation of parental advocacy intended to shield the District from liability.

III. REQUESTED ACTION

The Complainant respectfully requests that the Board of School Administrators initiate a formal investigation into the professional conduct of Superintendent Michael Thomas. The evidence demonstrates a persistent pattern of behavior that violates the standards of safety, honesty, and confidentiality mandated for licensed administrators in the state of Minnesota. Given his impending transition to a new educational leadership role, an immediate review of his administrative license is necessary to protect the integrity of the profession and the safety of students.

Respectfully Submitted,

[Redacted Signature]

[Redacted Title]

Itemized Redaction List

Bates/Page	Line	Redaction reason
Sean_OBrien_2026-05-12_BOSA-p001	4	Redacted to protect personal privacy.
Sean_OBrien_2026-05-12_BOSA-p001	6	Redacted to protect personal privacy.
Sean_OBrien_2026-05-12_BOSA-p002	28	Redacted to protect personal privacy.
Sean_OBrien_2026-05-12_BOSA-p002	29	Redacted to protect personal privacy.